

Northstar Technologies Policy Handbook

Synthetic educational corpus - not legal advice.

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Contents

Policy ID	Document
POL-PTO-001	Paid Time Off and Vacation Policy
POL-HOL-001	Holidays and Office Closures
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POL-INT-001	International and Out-of-Jurisdiction Work
POL-SEC-001	Information Security for Remote Workers
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POL-ONB-001	New Employee Onboarding
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POL-CON-001	Workplace Conduct and Reporting
POL-HRC-001	HR Case Management and Escalation

Review note

The runtime RAG corpus is the `runtime_corpus/` folder. This combined handbook and the individual review PDFs are review artifacts and should not be indexed with the runtime files because that would duplicate content.

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Paid Time Off and Vacation Policy

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Metadata	Value
Policy ID	POL-PTO-001
Version	1.0
Status	Active
Effective date	2026-09-01
Review date	2027-09-01
Policy owner	People Operations
Approver	Chief People Officer
Applies to	Regular full-time and regular part-time employees unless a written agreement or applicable law provides otherwise
Classification	Internal

PTO-1. Purpose

This policy establishes a consistent method for earning, requesting, approving, using, carrying over, and recording paid time off (PTO). PTO is intended for planned vacation, personal appointments, rest, and other discretionary time away from work. Medical, statutory, caregiving, bereavement, and other protected absences are handled under **POL-LEV-001** and must not be incorrectly classified as vacation.

PTO-2. Scope and policy precedence

This policy applies to employees whose offer letter or employment agreement identifies them as Regular Full-Time (RFT) or Regular Part-Time (RPT). Temporary employees, interns, agency workers, and contractors receive PTO only when a written agreement or applicable law says so. Where law or a signed agreement provides a greater right, the greater right applies.

PTO-3. Definitions

- **Business day:** Monday through Friday, excluding a holiday on the employee's assigned holiday calendar.
- **Scheduled workday:** A day the employee is expected to work under the approved schedule.
- **PTO day:** Eight hours for administrative conversion. Actual deductions use the employee's scheduled hours for the day.
- **Service year:** Completed continuous service measured from the employee's recognized service date.
- **Available balance:** Accrued PTO shown in the HR system, less approved future requests and any adjustments.

PTO-4. Eligibility and accrual

PTO accrues each pay period from the employee's recognized service date. New hires receive a prorated accrual for the remainder of the calendar year. Employees may use accrued PTO after 30 calendar days of employment unless People Operations approves an earlier use or applicable law requires otherwise.

Employment category and completed service	Annual full-time entitlement	Administrative hours
RFT, less than 5 completed years	15 days	120 hours
RFT, 5 through 9 completed years	20 days	160 hours
RFT, 10 or more completed years	25 days	200 hours
RPT, 20-29 scheduled hours per week	Prorated from the applicable service tier	Tier hours x scheduled weekly hours / 40

Service-tier increases take effect at the start of the pay period containing the employee's service anniversary. Accrual continues during paid leave. Accrual may pause after 30 consecutive calendar days of unpaid leave unless law, a benefit plan, or a written leave approval requires continuation.

PTO-5. Rules for using PTO

1. PTO may be used only against scheduled work time.
2. Company holidays are not deducted from PTO.
3. PTO may be requested in half-day increments. A smaller increment may be used when required by law, an approved accommodation, or a local timekeeping rule.
4. Employees may not create a negative PTO balance. People Operations may approve an advance of up to 16 hours only for a documented payroll correction or exceptional business transition; this is not a routine benefit.
5. Employees must not perform work while recorded as on PTO unless a manager asks the employee to address an urgent matter and the PTO record is corrected.
6. PTO does not replace required attendance, performance, or availability expectations.

PTO-6. Notice and request process

Requests must be submitted through the approved HR system and include dates, partial-day details, and any known coverage plan.

Consecutive PTO requested	Normal minimum notice
1-2 scheduled workdays	5 business days
3-5 scheduled workdays	10 business days
6 or more scheduled workdays	20 business days

Unexpected needs should be reported to the manager as soon as reasonably possible. Short notice does not automatically disqualify a request, but approval may depend on coverage and business impact.

The employee's manager is the normal approver. A manager requesting more than 10 consecutive business days requires approval from the next-level manager and People Operations. People Operations may review any request involving a policy exception, overlapping leave, or an inaccurate balance.

PTO-7. Approval criteria and scheduling conflicts

Managers must consider operational coverage, customer commitments, deadlines, fairness across the team, prior approvals, and the employee's opportunity to use accrued time. Approval must not be withheld for a discriminatory or retaliatory reason.

When requests conflict, managers should first seek voluntary alternatives. If no alternative is available, the manager may consider the order of complete requests, critical role coverage, prior high-demand approvals, and equitable rotation. A "first come, first served" rule is not absolute.

Teams may establish limited critical-period restrictions only with director and People Operations approval and at least 30 calendar days' notice. Restrictions must identify the business reason, dates, affected roles, and an exception path.

PTO-8. Changes, cancellation, and illness during PTO

Employees must promptly update a request when dates change. Managers should avoid canceling approved PTO. If a documented business emergency requires cancellation, the director and People Operations must approve the change, and reasonable non-refundable costs caused solely by the cancellation may be reviewed under **POL-EXP-001**.

An employee who becomes ill or experiences another qualifying event during approved PTO may ask People Operations to reclassify eligible days under **POL-LEV-001**. Supporting information may be required, but the employee should not disclose more medical information than necessary.

PTO-9. Carryover and year-end treatment

Up to 40 hours of unused PTO may carry into the next calendar year. Carried hours should be used by March 31. Unused carryover after March 31 expires unless law, a written agreement, or a documented inability to take approved PTO requires a different result.

Managers must review high balances by October 1 and create a reasonable use plan with the employee. Employees remain responsible for submitting requests; a high balance does not create automatic approval for specific dates.

PTO-10. Separation and status changes

Unused PTO is paid, forfeited, or otherwise treated according to applicable law and the employee's written agreement. The HR system calculation must be reviewed when an employee changes between full-time and part-time status, transfers jurisdictions, or has a corrected service date.

PTO-11. Roles and responsibilities

- **Employee:** Maintain accurate requests, provide reasonable notice, monitor the balance, and coordinate coverage.
- **Manager:** Decide requests consistently, document exceptions, protect employees from retaliation, and support reasonable use of accrued PTO.
- **People Operations:** Maintain rules and balances, resolve disputes, interpret interactions with leave and law, and audit adjustments.
- **Payroll:** Process approved balances and separation payments using authorized records.

PTO-12. Exceptions, questions, and records

Policy exceptions require People Operations approval and, when they materially affect cost or coverage, director approval. Questions or disputes may be submitted under **POL-HRC-001**. PTO requests, approvals, adjustments, and balance transactions are retained in the HR system according to the corporate records schedule.

PTO-13. Examples

- An employee requesting three scheduled workdays next week should normally provide 10 business days' notice, confirm sufficient available balance, and obtain manager approval.
- A holiday occurring during a five-day vacation is not deducted from PTO.
- An employee with 24 available hours cannot submit a 32-hour request unless the dates are changed or a rare advance is approved.
- A six-week absence is not automatically a PTO matter. People Operations must determine whether part of the time is leave, an approved extended vacation, or another arrangement.

Related policies and records

- **POL-HOL-001 - Holidays and Office Closures**
- **POL-LEV-001 - Statutory, Medical, and Personal Leave**
- **POL-HRC-001 - HR Case Management and Escalation**

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Holidays and Office Closures

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Metadata	Value
Policy ID	POL-HOL-001
Version	1.0
Status	Active
Effective date	2026-09-01
Review date	2027-09-01
Policy owner	People Operations
Approver	Chief People Officer
Applies to	Employees of Northstar Technologies Inc.; holiday pay and substitute-day treatment may vary by employment category and jurisdiction
Classification	Internal

HOL-1. Purpose

This policy defines company holiday calendars, floating holidays, substitute days, work performed on a holiday, and closures caused by weather, building conditions, public emergencies, or company decisions.

HOL-2. Assigned holiday calendar

Each employee is assigned a holiday calendar based on the Registered Home Office in the HR system, not the employee's temporary travel location. Vancouver and Toronto employees normally follow the Canada calendar. Seattle and Austin employees normally follow the United States calendar. A written employment agreement or local legal requirement may create a different calendar.

People Operations publishes the next year's calendar by December 1. A calendar may be updated when a government changes an observed date or when Northstar designates an additional closure.

HOL-3. Eligibility and pay treatment

RFT employees receive holiday pay for the scheduled hours that would normally be worked, up to eight hours, unless a local rule provides more. RPT employees receive holiday pay when the holiday falls on a normally scheduled workday, prorated to the scheduled hours, unless law requires another calculation.

Temporary employees and interns receive holiday pay only when required by law or stated in a written agreement. Contractors are not employees and do not receive company holiday pay.

HOL-4. 2026 Canada holiday calendar

The following company calendar applies to employees assigned to Vancouver or Toronto unless their written terms state otherwise.

Date	Day	Holiday or closure
January 1, 2026	Thursday	New Year's Day
February 16, 2026	Monday	Family Day
April 3, 2026	Friday	Good Friday
May 18, 2026	Monday	Victoria Day
July 1, 2026	Wednesday	Canada Day
August 3, 2026	Monday	Provincial/Civic Holiday
September 7, 2026	Monday	Labour Day
September 30, 2026	Wednesday	National Day for Truth and Reconciliation - company observance
October 12, 2026	Monday	Thanksgiving
November 11, 2026	Wednesday	Remembrance Day - company observance
December 25, 2026	Friday	Christmas Day
December 28, 2026	Monday	Boxing Day observed

HOL-5. 2026 United States holiday calendar

The following company calendar applies to employees assigned to Seattle or Austin unless their written terms state otherwise.

Date	Day	Holiday or closure
January 1, 2026	Thursday	New Year's Day
January 19, 2026	Monday	Martin Luther King Jr. Day
February 16, 2026	Monday	Presidents Day
May 25, 2026	Monday	Memorial Day
June 19, 2026	Friday	Juneteenth
July 3, 2026	Friday	Independence Day observed
September 7, 2026	Monday	Labor Day
November 26, 2026	Thursday	Thanksgiving
November 27, 2026	Friday	Company closure
December 24, 2026	Thursday	Year-end company day
December 25, 2026	Friday	Christmas Day

HOL-6. Floating holiday

Each RFT and RPT employee receives one floating holiday per calendar year. A floating holiday:

- may be used for a cultural, religious, civic, or personal observance;
- should normally be requested at least five business days in advance;
- is deducted based on the employee's scheduled hours, up to eight hours;
- requires manager approval for operational coverage;
- does not carry over after December 31; and
- is not paid out at separation unless required by law.

A new employee hired on or before September 30 receives the floating holiday for that year. A later hire does not receive it unless the offer letter says otherwise.

HOL-7. Weekend observance and substitute days

When a fixed-date holiday falls on a weekend, the published calendar identifies the observed weekday. Employees must use the published date rather than independently selecting another day.

An employee required and preapproved to work on a company holiday may receive a substitute paid day, premium pay, or another legally required treatment. The manager must consult People Operations before promising a specific result. A substitute day should normally be used within 60 calendar days.

HOL-8. Holiday during PTO or leave

A paid company holiday during approved PTO is recorded as a holiday and is not deducted from the employee's PTO balance. Holiday pay during a statutory, medical, personal, or unpaid leave is determined under **POL-LEV-001**, the relevant benefit plan, and applicable law.

HOL-9. Office closures and delayed openings

Northstar may close a physical office or announce a delayed opening because of severe weather, utility failure, unsafe building conditions, transportation disruption, public emergency, or another material risk.

- Employees able to work safely from an approved location should normally work remotely unless the closure notice states that operations are suspended.
- Employees who cannot work remotely must contact their manager. People Operations will determine pay or time-recording treatment based on employment status, local requirements, and the closure notice.
- Employees must not travel to a closed office to retrieve equipment without Facilities or Security approval.
- A school or dependent-care closure does not automatically close Northstar. Employees should discuss PTO, flexible hours, or leave options with the manager.

HOL-10. Essential coverage

Some support, security, infrastructure, and customer operations may require holiday coverage. Managers must identify essential coverage in advance, use an equitable rotation where practical, and confirm time-recording or substitute-day treatment before the shift.

HOL-11. Religious and cultural accommodation

An employee who needs time away for an observance not on the assigned calendar may use the floating holiday, PTO, a schedule adjustment, unpaid time, or an accommodation. Requests are handled individually and must not be denied for a discriminatory or retaliatory reason.

HOL-12. Responsibilities and records

People Operations owns the calendars. Managers communicate coverage and approve floating holidays. Employees verify their assigned calendar and promptly report an incorrect assignment. Holiday calendars, closure notices, substitute-day approvals, and pay adjustments are retained in the HR or payroll system.

HOL-13. Examples

- A Vancouver employee temporarily working in Germany continues to follow the Canada holiday calendar unless an approved international-work decision says otherwise.
- A Toronto employee on PTO from December 24 through December 31, 2026 is not charged PTO for December 25 or December 28.
- A Seattle employee required to work on November 27 must have the arrangement and resulting pay or substitute day confirmed in advance.
- A remote-capable employee normally works from home when the assigned office closes because of snow, unless the notice suspends operations.

Related policies and records

- **POL-PTO-001 - Paid Time Off and Vacation Policy**
- **POL-LEV-001 - Statutory, Medical, and Personal Leave**
- **POL-RWK-001 - Remote and Hybrid Work Policy**

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Remote and Hybrid Work Policy

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Policy ID	POL-RWK-001
Version	1.0
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Effective date	2026-09-01
Review date	2027-09-01
Policy owner	People Operations
Approver	Chief People Officer
Applies to	Employees with an Office-Based, Hybrid, or Remote work designation; contractors only when their agreement incorporates this policy
Classification	Internal

RWK-1. Purpose

This policy establishes work-location designations, eligibility, approval, schedule, performance, safety, security, equipment, and travel expectations for remote and hybrid work. It does not authorize work outside the employee's registered province, state, or country; those requests are governed by **POL-INT-001**.

RWK-2. Work-location designations

Every employee record must contain one of the following designations and a Registered Home Office.

Designation	Normal expectation
Office-Based	Works primarily from the assigned office. Occasional remote work of up to two days per calendar month may be approved by the manager.
Hybrid	Works from the assigned office at least two days per week or the greater team standard, and from the approved home workspace on other approved days.
Remote	Works primarily from the approved home workspace and attends planned onsite events or customer locations when required.

A manager may set common team anchor days. A designation is not an entitlement and does not prevent reasonable changes for business, performance, security, accommodation, or legal reasons.

RWK-3. Eligibility

A role is eligible only when its duties can be performed without material loss of customer service, collaboration, supervision, security, equipment access, or operational continuity. The manager and People Operations consider:

- role duties and need for physical presence;
- access to Confidential or Restricted data;
- performance, reliability, and ability to work independently;
- the proposed workspace, connectivity, and time-zone overlap;
- team coverage and customer commitments; and
- jurisdiction, payroll, tax, immigration, licensing, or client restrictions.

A recurring Hybrid or Remote arrangement normally begins after the first 60 calendar days of employment unless the employee was hired into that designation, an accommodation applies, or People Operations approves an earlier start.

RWK-4. Approval and review

A new or changed designation requires a documented request, manager recommendation, and People Operations approval. Information Security approval is also required when the role regularly handles Restricted data outside an office.

Approved arrangements are reviewed at least annually and when the employee changes role, manager, home address, jurisdiction, performance status, or client assignment. Silence or informal past practice is not approval.

RWK-5. Approved work location

Remote work may occur only at the approved home workspace or another location expressly approved for the relevant dates. The employee must keep the residential address and Registered Home Office current in the HR system.

Any work outside the registered province or state, including within the same country, must be assessed under **POL-INT-001** before travel. Working from another country while on personal vacation is still work and requires approval.

Public cafes, hotel lobbies, shared lounges, and transportation terminals are not approved locations for handling Confidential or Restricted information. A private coworking space may be approved when Security and the manager confirm appropriate controls.

RWK-6. Schedule, availability, and time zones

Employees must follow an approved schedule and comply with timekeeping requirements. Unless a team has a different documented schedule, employees must be available during core collaboration hours of 10:00 a.m. to 3:00 p.m. in the employee's Registered Home Office time zone.

Remote work is not a substitute for dependent care during working hours. Brief, incidental interruptions are expected in normal life; recurring care needs require an approved schedule, PTO, or leave arrangement.

Employees must maintain calendar visibility, attend required meetings, respond within reasonable team norms, and notify the manager of outages or material schedule changes.

RWK-7. Performance and conduct

Performance, attendance, conduct, confidentiality, and customer-service standards are the same regardless of location. Managers should assess results and behavior rather than online presence alone. Surveillance tools may not be installed or used outside approved security and compliance processes.

A remote arrangement may be modified or ended when documented performance, collaboration, security, customer, or operational needs cannot be resolved. When practical, Northstar provides reasonable notice and an opportunity to discuss alternatives. Immediate changes may be required for a security, safety, legal, or client risk.

RWK-8. Workspace, health, and safety

The employee must maintain a reasonably safe, private, and functional workspace with adequate lighting, seating, electrical capacity, and internet access. Work-related injuries must be reported promptly to the manager and People Operations, even when they occur at home.

Northstar may request a self-assessment, photographs of company equipment placement, or a virtual ergonomic review. Northstar will not routinely inspect a residence without consent, but may require a different approved location when material risks cannot be addressed.

RWK-9. Information security and privacy

Employees must comply with **POL-SEC-001**, including company-managed device, multifactor authentication, VPN, screen privacy, storage, printing, and incident-reporting rules. Household members and visitors must not use company devices or view non-public company information.

Confidential conversations require a private setting and a headset when others may overhear. Paper containing Confidential or Restricted information should not be printed at home unless expressly approved and securely destroyed.

RWK-10. Equipment and expenses

Company equipment, home-office accessories, furniture reimbursement, internet stipends, repair, loss, and return are governed by **POL-EQP-001**. Reimbursements require compliance with **POL-EXP-001**. Employees should not purchase equipment with an expectation of reimbursement before receiving required approval.

RWK-11. Travel to an office or customer site

Normal travel between a Hybrid or Office-Based employee's residence and assigned office is commuting and is not reimbursable. Required travel by a Remote-designated employee to an office more than 50 kilometres or 30 miles from the approved home workspace is business travel when preapproved.

Remote employees may be required to attend up to four planned onsite events per calendar year with reasonable notice. Additional travel may be required by the role or employment agreement.

RWK-12. Business continuity

Employees should maintain a practical continuity plan for short internet or power outages. This may include a company-approved hotspot, alternate approved workspace, adjusted hours, PTO, or office attendance. Employees must not use an insecure location solely to remain online.

RWK-13. Responsibilities

- **Employee:** Maintain accurate location information, protect data, meet schedule and performance expectations, and report incidents.
- **Manager:** Assess role suitability consistently, define team norms, monitor outcomes, and escalate jurisdiction or security questions.
- **People Operations:** Approve designations, maintain records, coordinate accommodations, and interpret policy.
- **Information Security and IT:** Define technical controls, approve exceptions, and support secure equipment and access.

RWK-14. Examples

- A Hybrid employee may not independently work from another province for three weeks. The request must be reviewed under **POL-INT-001**.
- A Remote employee using a private home office may handle Confidential information on a company-managed device with required security controls.
- An Office-Based employee may request an occasional remote day, but repeated weekly remote work requires a designation review.
- A Remote employee required to attend a company summit in another city may claim preapproved business travel; a Hybrid employee's normal trip to the assigned office is commuting.

Related policies and records

- **POL-INT-001 - International and Out-of-Jurisdiction Work**
- **POL-SEC-001 - Information Security for Remote Workers**
- **POL-EQP-001 - Company Equipment and Home Office Equipment**
- **POL-EXP-001 - Business Expenses and Reimbursements**

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International and Out-of-Jurisdiction Work

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Metadata	Value
Policy ID	POL-INT-001
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Status	Active
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Review date	2027-09-01
Policy owner	People Operations
Approver	Chief People Officer and Chief Financial Officer
Applies to	Employees proposing to perform work outside their registered province, state, or country, even temporarily
Classification	Internal

INT-1. Purpose

This policy manages legal, tax, payroll, immigration, information-security, insurance, client, and operational risks when an employee proposes to work outside the province, state, or country recorded as the employee's Registered Home Office.

Approval is case-specific, revocable, and not guaranteed. Approval does not change the employee's employment location, payroll jurisdiction, compensation, benefits, or right to work unless a separate written agreement says so.

INT-2. Scope

The policy applies whenever an employee performs any work outside the registered province or state, including email, meetings, coding, customer support, or document access during personal travel. It applies to domestic and international locations. Pure vacation with no work is not covered, but **POL-PTO-001** still applies.

INT-3. Definitions

- **Domestic out-of-jurisdiction work:** Work in another province or state within the employee's payroll country.
- **International work:** Work in a country other than the employee's payroll country.
- **Business day worked:** Any day on which the employee performs more than incidental work, regardless of hours.
- **Standard-Risk location:** A location currently permitted for routine review under the country-risk framework.
- **Enhanced-Review location:** A location requiring additional Legal, Security, insurance, client, or export-control assessment.
- **Prohibited location:** A location from which Northstar does not permit work because required controls or legal conditions cannot be met.

INT-4. Baseline eligibility

The employee must normally:

- be RFT or RPT and have completed 90 calendar days of service;
- be meeting performance and conduct expectations;
- have a role that can be performed from the proposed location;
- use company-managed equipment and approved connectivity;
- maintain required time-zone overlap and customer coverage;
- have no client, licensing, export-control, or data-residency restriction that prevents the arrangement; and
- demonstrate a lawful basis to be present and work in the destination.

An employee is responsible for truthful travel and authorization information. Northstar does not provide personal immigration or tax advice.

INT-5. Duration categories, notice, and normal limits

Category	Duration	Normal advance notice	Normal decision path
Domestic short-term	1-10 business days in a rolling 90 days	10 business days	Manager + People Operations acknowledgment
Domestic extended	11-30 business days in a rolling 12 months	20 business days	Manager + director + People Operations + Payroll/Tax + Security
International short-term	1-20 business days in a rolling 12 months	20 business days	Manager + director + People Operations + Security + Finance/Tax
International exceptional	21-30 business days in a rolling 12 months	30 business days	All short-term approvals + VP sponsor + Legal review
Assignment or location change	More than 30 business days, recurring residence, or permanent move	At least 60 calendar days	Formal mobility, transfer, or employment-location process; not a temporary-work approval

The normal aggregate limit is 30 domestic out-of-jurisdiction business days and 20 international business days in any rolling 12-month period. An international period of 21-30 days is exceptional and requires a documented business or compelling personal rationale. Days need not be consecutive to count.

INT-6. Required request information

A complete request must include:

1. employee ID, role, manager, and Registered Home Office;
2. destination city, region, and country;
3. arrival and departure dates and expected business days worked;
4. reason for the request and whether the travel is personal or business;
5. work schedule and time-zone overlap;
6. systems, data classifications, customers, and regulated activities involved;
7. proposed workspace, network, equipment, and emergency contact method;
8. immigration or work-authorization basis known to the employee; and
9. any prior out-of-jurisdiction days in the rolling 12-month period.

An incomplete request may be returned for clarification rather than denied.

INT-7. Review factors

Approvers assess, as applicable:

- immigration and permission to work;
- income-tax withholding, payroll registration, social contributions, and corporate permanent-establishment risk;
- employment standards, licensing, sanctions, export controls, and local registration;
- health, travel, workers' compensation, and insurance coverage;
- cybersecurity, data residency, government access, and device inspection risk;
- customer contracts and Restricted-data access;
- time-zone coverage, productivity, and emergency support; and
- the cumulative duration and pattern of prior approvals.

No single approver may waive another function's legal or security requirement.

INT-8. Country-risk framework

For this synthetic policy corpus, the following examples apply. Security and Legal may change classifications at any time.

Classification	Examples	General treatment
Standard-Risk	Canada, United States, European Economic Area including Germany, United Kingdom, Switzerland, Australia, New Zealand, Japan, Singapore, South Korea	Eligible for normal review; approval still required
Enhanced Review	Any destination not listed as Standard-Risk or Prohibited	Additional Security and Legal review; controls may include restricted access or shorter duration
Prohibited	A destination identified by Security or Legal as subject to sanctions, active conflict, unacceptable cyber risk, or inability to support employees	Work is not approved

A location's classification does not confirm immigration permission or tax acceptability.

INT-9. Information-security conditions

POL-SEC-001 applies at all times. International approvals normally require:

- company-managed device, current patches, disk encryption, MFA, and company VPN;
- no use of shared or public computers;
- no printing or local storage of Restricted information;
- private workspace and secure device storage;
- immediate reporting of device loss, border inspection, credential concerns, or suspected compromise; and
- explicit Security approval before accessing Restricted data outside the payroll country.

Security may issue a travel device, restrict applications, disable downloads, or require password changes after return.

INT-10. Conduct, representation, and local activity

An employee must not, without specific written authority:

- sign contracts or create a local business presence;
- hire or manage local workers outside an approved structure;
- represent that Northstar has an office in the destination;
- change the payroll address or employment location based only on temporary approval;
- perform regulated work requiring a local license; or
- continue working after approval expires.

INT-11. Costs, insurance, and emergencies

Personal-travel costs are not reimbursable. Business costs require preapproval under **POL-EXP-001**. The employee is responsible for personal travel documents and personal tax advice unless the request is a company-directed assignment.

An employee who cannot return as planned must contact the manager and People Operations before continuing work. An emergency extension is not automatic; work may be suspended until required approvals are obtained.

INT-12. Decision outcomes

A request may be:

- **Approved** for the stated dates and conditions;
- **Approved with conditions**, such as reduced duration, limited systems, specific hours, or a travel device;
- **Returned for clarification**;
- **Escalated** for Legal, Security, tax, client, or executive review; or
- **Not approved** when risks cannot be reasonably controlled.

The decision and conditions are recorded in the HR case system. A material change in destination, dates, duties, data, or travel status requires a new review.

INT-13. Example - six weeks in Germany

A British Columbia employee asking to work from Germany for six calendar weeks would normally propose about 30 business days. Germany is a Standard-Risk example, but the duration falls in the **International exceptional** category. The employee should submit the request at least 30 business days in advance. Approval would require the manager, director, People Operations, Security, Finance/Tax, a VP sponsor, and Legal review. The employee must also demonstrate a lawful basis to work, comply with security controls, maintain required time-zone overlap, and remain within cumulative limits. The request is not automatically approved merely because Germany is Standard-Risk.

INT-14. Responsibilities and records

Employees submit complete, accurate requests and follow all conditions. Managers assess business feasibility and coverage. People Operations coordinates the review and retains the decision. Security, Finance/Tax, Legal,

and client owners assess risks within their authority. Questions or disputed outcomes may be documented under **POL-HRC-001**, but an appeal does not authorize work while review is pending.

Related policies and records

- **POL-RWK-001 - Remote and Hybrid Work Policy**
- **POL-SEC-001 - Information Security for Remote Workers**
- **POL-EXP-001 - Business Expenses and Reimbursements**
- **POL-HRC-001 - HR Case Management and Escalation**

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Information Security for Remote Workers

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Metadata	Value
Policy ID	POL-SEC-001
Version	1.0
Status	Active
Effective date	2026-09-01
Review date	2027-09-01
Policy owner	Information Security
Approver	Chief Information Security Officer
Applies to	Employees, contractors, and authorized third parties accessing Northstar information away from a controlled Northstar office
Classification	Internal

SEC-1. Purpose

This policy establishes minimum information-security controls for remote, hybrid, mobile, and international work. It protects Northstar, employee, customer, and partner information while enabling approved work outside a controlled office.

SEC-2. Data classification

Classification	Examples	Remote-work rule
Public	Published website, approved press release, public job posting	May be handled in ordinary approved business tools

Classification	Examples	Remote-work rule
Internal	Internal procedures, routine team notes, non-sensitive project plans	Use approved accounts and services; avoid unnecessary local copies
Confidential	Employee records, customer information, contracts, source code, non-public financial data	Company-managed device, MFA, encryption, and approved storage required
Restricted	Authentication secrets, highly sensitive HR investigations, regulated data, production keys, security incident evidence	Explicit access authorization and enhanced controls; no remote printing or unapproved international access

When uncertain, employees must treat information as Confidential until the owner or Security confirms otherwise.

SEC-3. Approved devices and accounts

Confidential or Restricted information may be accessed only from a company-managed device or a specifically approved managed device. Personal computers may not download, synchronize, or store Northstar information. Limited browser access to low-risk Internal information may be allowed only through approved services with MFA and no local download.

Employees must:

- use unique company credentials and MFA;
- never share passwords, tokens, badges, or devices;
- install only approved software;
- allow required patching, encryption, endpoint protection, and device management;
- lock the screen when unattended; and
- use the approved password manager for company secrets.

SEC-4. Network security

The company VPN must be used when required by the application, Security notice, or data classification. Home Wi-Fi must use WPA2 or stronger security with a non-default administrator password.

Public Wi-Fi should be avoided. When no safer option exists, the employee must use a company hotspot or VPN and must not access Restricted information. Captive portals, shared hotel business centres, public computers, and unknown charging/data cables must not be used for company work.

SEC-5. Workspace privacy

Employees must position screens and conversations to prevent unauthorized viewing or listening. A headset and private room are required for Confidential discussions when others may overhear. Household members, guests, and service providers must not use company equipment or access company information.

Employees working in temporary lodging must secure devices when leaving the room and avoid leaving badges, notes, or equipment visible. Devices should remain in carry-on possession during travel.

SEC-6. Storage, sharing, and printing

Company information must be stored in approved company repositories. Employees must not forward company information to personal email, consumer file-sharing services, personal messaging accounts, or removable media.

Printing Confidential information at home requires a documented business need and manager approval. Printing Restricted information outside a controlled office is prohibited unless Security approves a specific exception. Approved paper records must be locked when not in use and destroyed through an approved secure method.

External sharing must use approved channels, least-privilege access, an appropriate expiration date, and verification of the recipient.

SEC-7. Collaboration, recording, and AI tools

Meetings may be recorded only when participants are notified and the recording is stored in an approved location. Employees must not paste Confidential or Restricted information into public generative-AI tools, public code assistants, public translation tools, or unapproved browser extensions.

Approved enterprise AI services may be used only within their documented data-classification limits. Restricted information requires explicit Security and data-owner approval even when the tool is company licensed.

SEC-8. International and mobile work

POL-INT-001 approval is required before working outside the registered province or state. Standard-Risk location status does not remove security requirements.

Security may require a travel device, application restrictions, read-only access, download blocking, temporary credentials, device inspection after return, or complete suspension of access. Restricted information may not be accessed outside the payroll country without explicit written Security approval.

Employees must immediately report unexpected border inspection of a company device, forced credential disclosure, device detention, or any request to install software.

SEC-9. Physical security and equipment loss

Company equipment must be protected against theft, damage, and unauthorized access. A lost or stolen device, badge, security key, or phone used for MFA must be reported to Security and the manager within one hour of discovery. Employees should not delay reporting while searching for the item.

Security may remotely lock or wipe equipment. Employees must cooperate with replacement, credential reset, incident review, and police or insurer documentation where appropriate.

SEC-10. Security incidents and accidental disclosure

Report immediately, and no later than one hour after discovery, any suspected phishing success, malware, credential compromise, unauthorized access, accidental external sharing, misdirected email containing Confidential information, or loss of sensitive paper.

Employees should preserve evidence, stop further sharing, disconnect a device from networks when instructed, and avoid independently deleting logs or negotiating with an attacker. Security owns technical containment. People Operations owns employee-related case coordination when the incident involves HR information or conduct.

SEC-11. Monitoring and privacy

Northstar may log access, device health, network connections, file sharing, and security events for legitimate security, legal, and operational purposes. Monitoring must be proportionate, authorized, and consistent with applicable law. Managers may not deploy informal surveillance or require employees to keep a camera continuously active.

SEC-12. Exceptions

A security exception must identify the business need, data, duration, compensating controls, owner, and expiration date. The Chief Information Security Officer or delegate must approve exceptions involving Confidential or Restricted information. Convenience alone is not sufficient.

SEC-13. Enforcement and responsibilities

Employees and contractors are responsible for following controls and reporting concerns promptly. Managers must not pressure staff to bypass security for speed. IT maintains devices and identity services. Security defines controls, investigates incidents, and may suspend access when needed to protect Northstar.

Violations may result in access restriction, corrective action, contract consequences, or legal referral, depending on severity and intent. Good-faith incident reporting is encouraged and will not itself be treated as misconduct.

SEC-14. Examples

- A Remote employee may review a Confidential customer contract at home on a company laptop using approved storage and required VPN.
- An employee may not upload source code to a public AI assistant, even to debug an urgent problem.
- A traveller in Germany needs the approved international-work decision and must not access Restricted HR case files unless Security explicitly authorizes it.
- A lost phone used for MFA must be reported within one hour, even if the phone has a passcode.

Related policies and records

- **POL-RWK-001 - Remote and Hybrid Work Policy**
- **POL-INT-001 - International and Out-of-Jurisdiction Work**
- **POL-EQP-001 - Company Equipment and Home Office Equipment**
- **POL-CON-001 - Workplace Conduct and Reporting**
- **POL-HRC-001 - HR Case Management and Escalation**

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Business Expenses and Reimbursements

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Metadata	Value
Policy ID	POL-EXP-001
Version	1.0
Status	Active
Effective date	2026-09-01
Review date	2027-09-01
Policy owner	Finance
Approver	Chief Financial Officer
Applies to	Employees and authorized contingent workers incurring preapproved Northstar business expenses
Classification	Internal

EXP-1. Purpose

This policy defines when Northstar pays or reimburses business expenses, which approvals and evidence are required, and which costs are not reimbursable. Expenses must be reasonable, necessary, properly authorized, accurately documented, and connected to a legitimate Northstar business purpose.

EXP-2. General principles

1. Use an approved supplier, booking channel, corporate card, or company-provided item when available.
2. Obtain preapproval when the category or amount requires it.
3. Choose the lowest reasonable total-cost option, considering safety, time, accessibility, and business needs.
4. Separate personal and business costs.
5. Submit accurate claims within 30 calendar days after the expense or trip.
6. Never divide a purchase to avoid an approval threshold.

Northstar may decline a cost that is excessive, personal, unsupported, late without explanation, or purchased contrary to policy.

EXP-3. Approval thresholds

Thresholds use the employee's normal expense currency. The CAD and USD amounts are policy equivalents, not exchange-rate conversions.

Total commitment	Required preapproval
Below CAD 500 or USD 375	Manager, when the category requires preapproval; otherwise normal budget authority
CAD 500-2,499.99 or USD 375-1,874.99	Manager and director or designated budget owner
CAD 2,500 or USD 1,875 and above	Manager, VP, and Finance

All international travel, conferences, home-office furniture, non-standard technology, gifts above the routine limit, and exceptions require preapproval regardless of amount. Approval of a budget does not automatically approve an individual expense.

EXP-4. Receipts and claim submission

An itemized receipt is required for each expense of CAD 25/USD 20 or more and whenever Finance requests it. A card slip showing only a total is not itemized. If a receipt cannot reasonably be obtained, the employee must submit a missing-receipt declaration stating vendor, date, amount, purpose, and why the receipt is unavailable. Repeated missing receipts may be declined.

Claims must include the business purpose, attendees for hosted meals, project or cost centre, currency, taxes where shown, and proof of required preapproval. Managers should review claims within five business days.

EXP-5. Travel booking and transportation

Business travel must be booked through the approved channel when available.

- Economy airfare is standard for trips with scheduled flight time under six hours.
- Premium economy may be approved for a segment of six hours or more.
- Business class requires executive approval or an approved accommodation.
- Rail may be selected when total cost and travel time are reasonable.
- Ride-share, taxi, public transit, mileage, parking, and tolls are reimbursable when business-related and documented.
- Traffic, parking, and other personal fines are never reimbursable.
- A personal vehicle may be used only when licensed, insured, and suitable. Mileage is reimbursed at the current company rate; fuel is not separately reimbursed for the same trip.

Daily commuting between a residence and assigned office is not a business expense. Travel treatment for Remote-designated employees is described in **POL-RWK-001**.

EXP-6. Lodging and meals

Employees should select a safe, business-appropriate hotel within the rate displayed by the approved booking tool or obtain preapproval for a higher rate.

For overnight business travel, the guideline for employee meals is up to CAD 90 or USD 75 per day, excluding reasonable tax and tip. This is a maximum, not a per diem entitlement. Alcohol is reimbursable only for a preapproved client or company event and must be reasonable.

Hosted meals must identify attendees and business purpose. An employee may not approve the employee's own hosted-meal expense; the next-level manager must review it.

EXP-7. Home-office equipment and connectivity

Company-standard technology is procured under **POL-EQP-001** and should not be purchased personally. Eligible Hybrid and Remote employees may request preapproval for ergonomic furniture reimbursement up to **CAD 500 or USD 375 once every 36 months**. The limit applies to the combined approved chair, desk, or ergonomic accessories in the period.

An amount above the cap is personal unless an approved workplace accommodation authorizes a different amount. A CAD 900 chair is therefore not fully reimbursable under the ordinary program: when eligibility and preapproval are confirmed, reimbursement is limited to CAD 500, with the employee responsible for the remainder.

Remote-designated employees may receive the standard monthly internet stipend defined in **POL-EQP-001**. The employee may not claim the same connectivity cost again through an expense report.

EXP-8. Technology, subscriptions, and professional development

Software, devices, cloud services, and subscriptions require IT or Security review when they connect to company systems, store company information, or create recurring commitments. Personal purchases made without required review may be declined even when used for work.

Professional memberships, certifications, courses, and conferences require manager and budget approval. A reimbursement agreement may apply when the cost is material and the program is optional.

EXP-9. Gifts, entertainment, and conflicts

A business gift must be lawful, infrequent, transparent, and not intended to influence a decision. Gifts to one external recipient with a total value above CAD 100 or USD 75 in a calendar year require Finance or Compliance approval. Cash and cash equivalents are prohibited.

Employees must comply with conflict-of-interest and conduct requirements in **POL-CON-001**. Government officials and regulated customers may have stricter limits; obtain Legal or Compliance review before providing anything of value.

EXP-10. Non-reimbursable expenses

Examples include:

- personal travel, companion costs, sightseeing, and leisure extensions;
- upgrades or luxury items without required approval;
- commuting, ordinary clothing, personal grooming, and personal household costs;
- fines, penalties, towing caused by a violation, and personal legal costs;
- minibar, in-room entertainment, and personal subscriptions;
- unapproved equipment or software;
- duplicate claims, loyalty-point value, or costs already paid by another party; and
- expenses that violate law, contract, or company policy.

EXP-11. Foreign currency, tax, and reimbursement

Claims must state the original currency and amount. The expense system applies its standard conversion method. Employees should not manually add a foreign-exchange buffer. Finance may adjust tax treatment or require additional documentation.

Approved reimbursements are normally paid through payroll or accounts payable. Processing time may depend on a complete claim, manager approval, and local payment cycles.

EXP-12. Exceptions, audit, and misuse

An exception must be approved before purchase whenever practical and must state the business reason. Finance may audit claims, request clarification, recover overpayments, suspend card privileges, or escalate suspected fraud

under **POL-HRC-001** and **POL-CON-001**.

A good-faith error should be corrected promptly. Intentional falsification, duplicate claiming, or approval circumvention may result in corrective action.

EXP-13. Responsibilities

Employees make compliant choices and submit evidence. Managers verify business purpose, reasonableness, and budget. Budget owners confirm funding. Finance sets controls, processes payments, and audits claims. IT, Security, People Operations, Legal, and Compliance review categories within their authority.

EXP-14. Examples

- A CAD 900 chair for a Hybrid employee requires preapproval and is ordinarily reimbursable only up to CAD 500 once every 36 months.
- A three-day domestic trip booked through the approved tool with economy airfare, reasonable hotel, itemized receipts, and business purpose is normally eligible.
- A CAD 1,200 conference requires manager and director or budget-owner preapproval.
- A laptop purchased personally without IT approval is not reimbursable merely because it was used for work.

Related policies and records

- **POL-EQP-001 - Company Equipment and Home Office Equipment**
- **POL-RWK-001 - Remote and Hybrid Work Policy**
- **POL-INT-001 - International and Out-of-Jurisdiction Work**
- **POL-CON-001 - Workplace Conduct and Reporting**

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Employee Benefits Eligibility

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Metadata	Value
Policy ID	POL-BEN-001
Version	1.0
Status	Active
Effective date	2026-09-01
Review date	2027-09-01
Policy owner	People Operations
Approver	Chief People Officer
Applies to	Employees of Northstar Technologies Inc.; actual coverage is governed by the applicable benefit plan documents and insurer records
Classification	Internal

BEN-1. Purpose

This policy explains general eligibility, enrollment timing, status changes, dependent coverage, continuation during leave, and escalation for Northstar-sponsored benefits. It does not summarize every plan term. When this policy conflicts with an insurer, retirement-plan, or other formal plan document, the formal plan document controls unless applicable law provides otherwise.

BEN-2. Employment categories

- **Regular Full-Time (RFT):** Normally scheduled for 30 or more hours per week.
- **Regular Part-Time (RPT):** Normally scheduled for 20-29 hours per week.
- **Temporary employee or intern:** Hired for a defined period or program and not designated RFT or RPT.
- **Contractor:** A non-employee providing services under a commercial agreement.

Eligibility is based on the category in the HR system, average scheduled hours where required by the plan, location, and any written employment terms.

BEN-3. General eligibility matrix

Benefit category	RFT	RPT	Temporary/intern	Contractor
Employee Assistance Program (EAP)	Eligible from start date	Eligible from start date	Eligible only if program terms include the category	Not eligible
Core medical, dental, and vision	Eligible, subject to waiting period and local plan	Eligible only when normally scheduled at least 25 hours/week and the local plan permits	Not eligible unless written terms say otherwise	Not eligible
Company-paid life and disability	Eligible where offered by local plan	Normally not eligible unless local plan or written terms say otherwise	Not eligible unless written terms say otherwise	Not eligible
Retirement or savings plan	Eligible when plan age/service rules are met	Eligible when plan age/service rules are met	Plan-specific	Not eligible through Northstar
Voluntary benefits	Plan-specific	Plan-specific	Plan-specific	Not eligible

Applicable law may require a different result. The HR system's `benefits_status` record is the operational source for an individual employee, but plan administrators make final coverage determinations.

BEN-4. Coverage start and waiting period

For an otherwise eligible employee, core insured coverage normally begins on the first day of the calendar month after the employee completes 30 calendar days of eligible service. Example: an eligible employee starting September 10 normally has coverage effective November 1.

When a plan or local law requires earlier coverage, that requirement applies. A rehire, transfer, or status change may have special rules and must be reviewed by People Operations.

BEN-5. Enrollment window

An employee must complete required enrollment or waiver elections within 31 calendar days after the eligibility notice. Failure to act may result in default coverage, employee-only coverage, or no optional coverage, depending on the plan.

After the initial window, an employee may normally change elections only during annual open enrollment or within 31 calendar days after a qualifying life event, such as marriage, divorce, birth, adoption, or loss of other coverage. Evidence may be required.

BEN-6. Dependents and beneficiaries

Eligible dependents are defined by the applicable plan. Employees are responsible for accurate dependent information and timely removal of a person who is no longer eligible. Knowingly enrolling an ineligible person may result in repayment, loss of coverage, corrective action, or insurer action.

Beneficiary designations should be reviewed after major life events. A beneficiary shown in the HR portal is not necessarily valid for every plan; employees must complete plan-specific forms when required.

BEN-7. Employee contributions and payroll deductions

Employee premiums and contributions are deducted from payroll when the plan permits. Employees must review pay statements and report an apparent error promptly. Missed deductions may be collected prospectively or through a reasonable repayment arrangement.

Northstar may change contribution levels during open enrollment or when a plan changes, subject to notice and applicable requirements.

BEN-8. Changes in hours, role, or location

A change in employment category, scheduled hours, legal entity, province, state, or country may change eligibility, plan options, cost, or coverage date. The employee and manager must notify People Operations before a planned change. People Operations will provide an eligibility decision based on the applicable plan.

Temporary work approved under **POL-INT-001** does not automatically change benefits. Extended assignments or permanent moves require a separate benefits review.

BEN-9. Benefits during leave

Coverage during statutory, medical, parental, personal, or other leave is determined by **POL-LEV-001**, applicable law, and plan terms. During some unpaid leaves, an employee may need to pay the employee share of premiums directly. Failure to pay after required notice may result in coverage ending where legally permitted.

Paid PTO alone does not interrupt eligibility.

BEN-10. Separation and continuation options

Coverage normally ends on the date or at the end of the month specified by the applicable plan and separation notice. People Operations provides information about any conversion, continuation, or portability option for which the employee may qualify. Deadlines are controlled by the plan or law and should be acted on promptly.

BEN-11. Privacy and access

Benefits information is Confidential. Managers should not request diagnoses, claim details, or dependent medical information. People Operations and plan administrators access only information necessary to administer eligibility, enrollment, contributions, leave, or accommodation processes.

The AI assistant may report a synthetic employee's eligibility or enrollment status from mock data, but it must not invent coverage, diagnose a condition, or make a final insurer determination.

BEN-12. Appeals, corrections, and escalation

An employee who believes a record is incorrect should submit a benefits case under **POL-HRC-001** and include the employee ID, plan, event date, expected status, and any relevant notice. People Operations will correct Northstar records when appropriate or direct the employee to the plan's formal appeal process.

An urgent loss of medication access or active treatment should be marked high priority, but a service target is not a guarantee of insurer approval.

BEN-13. Responsibilities

Employees make timely and accurate elections, review deductions, and report changes. Managers notify People Operations of approved status changes without seeking medical details. People Operations administers eligibility and notices. Payroll processes authorized deductions. Plan administrators decide claims and plan-specific coverage.

BEN-14. Examples

- An RFT employee who has completed the waiting period is generally eligible for core benefits, subject to enrollment and plan terms.
- An RPT employee scheduled for 22 hours per week receives the EAP and may qualify for retirement benefits, but does not ordinarily qualify for core insured benefits under this policy.
- An RPT employee scheduled for 27 hours may be eligible for core insured benefits if the local plan permits and the employee enrolls on time.
- A contractor is not eligible for employee benefits merely because the contractor works full-time hours on a project.

Related policies and records

- **POL-LEV-001 - Statutory, Medical, and Personal Leave**
- **POL-ONB-001 - New Employee Onboarding**
- **POL-HRC-001 - HR Case Management and Escalation**

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Statutory, Medical, and Personal Leave

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Metadata	Value
Policy ID	POL-LEV-001
Version	1.0
Status	Active
Effective date	2026-09-01
Review date	2027-09-01
Policy owner	People Operations
Approver	Chief People Officer
Applies to	Employees requesting or using statutory, medical, caregiving, bereavement, civic, or personal leave
Classification	Internal

LEV-1. Purpose

This policy provides a common process for absences that are not ordinary vacation, including statutory, medical, wellness, caregiving, parental, bereavement, civic, emergency, and personal leave. Leave rights vary by location and circumstances. Northstar will apply the greater protection required by applicable law or a written agreement.

LEV-2. No loss of legal rights

Nothing in this policy limits a legally protected leave, accommodation, workers' compensation right, military or civic obligation, or other mandatory entitlement. Employees should contact People Operations because the correct classification affects pay, benefits, documentation, job protection, and records.

LEV-3. Paid wellness leave

RFT employees receive 80 hours of paid wellness leave each calendar year. RPT employees receive a prorated amount equal to 80 hours multiplied by scheduled weekly hours divided by 40, rounded to the nearest hour. Greater statutory paid-sick entitlement is provided when required.

Wellness leave may be used for the employee's illness, injury, medical appointment, preventive care, mental-health need, or qualifying care of a family or household member. It is separate from PTO, does not carry over, and is not paid out at separation unless law requires otherwise.

Employees should notify the manager before the scheduled start time when reasonably possible and provide an expected duration. Employees do not need to disclose a diagnosis to the manager.

LEV-4. Medical and disability leave

An employee who cannot work or needs intermittent time because of a medical condition should contact People Operations. People Operations will assess statutory leave, disability benefits, workplace accommodation, reduced schedule, and return-to-work requirements.

For an absence of more than three consecutive scheduled workdays, or when there is a reasonable pattern or safety need, Northstar may request appropriate documentation of functional limitations, expected duration, and ability to work. A diagnosis is requested only when necessary and lawful. Medical records are stored separately with restricted access.

LEV-5. Family, caregiving, parental, and statutory leave

Eligible employees may take family-responsibility, caregiving, pregnancy, parental, adoption, domestic-violence, military, public-health, or other statutory leave when the legal criteria are met. Duration, pay, notice, documentation, and benefit continuation are determined by the applicable jurisdiction and plan.

An employee should provide notice as soon as reasonably possible. People Operations will identify the available leave category and may ask only for information reasonably needed to administer it.

LEV-6. Bereavement leave

Northstar provides:

- up to five paid scheduled workdays after the death of an immediate family or household member; and
- up to three paid scheduled workdays after the death of an extended family member or another person with a comparably close relationship.

"Family" is interpreted inclusively and is not limited to biological or legal relationships. Additional PTO or unpaid leave may be approved. Travel, cultural, religious, and administrative needs should be considered. Documentation is not routinely required, but People Operations may request reasonable confirmation where necessary.

LEV-7. Jury, witness, election, and civic duty

Northstar provides paid leave for up to 10 scheduled workdays per calendar year for required jury duty or comparable civic service, less any amount that local rules require the employee to remit. Longer service is handled according to law and may be paid or unpaid. An employee must provide the summons or notice and report any early release from service.

Voluntary political activity is not civic-duty leave and should normally use PTO or unpaid time. Employees must comply with **POL-CON-001** regarding political activity and use of company resources.

LEV-8. Personal unpaid leave

After 12 months of service, an employee may request a personal unpaid leave of up to 30 calendar days for a compelling reason not covered by another leave. Approval is discretionary and considers duration, operational coverage, prior leaves, performance, and whether a protected leave or accommodation applies.

A personal leave longer than 30 days requires VP and People Operations approval and may require a formal employment arrangement. Employees must not use personal unpaid leave to work for a competitor or avoid a conduct process.

LEV-9. Request and notification process

When foreseeable, leave should be requested at least 30 calendar days in advance or as soon as the need is known. For an emergency, the employee or representative should notify the manager or People Operations as soon as reasonably possible.

A request should identify the expected start date, estimated duration, whether the leave may be intermittent, and a safe contact method. The employee should not send detailed medical information to a manager or a general team channel.

LEV-10. Pay, PTO, accrual, and benefits

People Operations will provide a written summary of whether each portion of leave is paid, unpaid, covered by wellness leave, covered by PTO at the employee's election, or supported by a benefit program.

PTO accrues during paid leave. It may pause after 30 consecutive calendar days of unpaid leave unless law or a written approval requires continuation. Benefits continue according to **POL-BEN-001**, law, and plan terms. Employees may be responsible for their normal premium share during unpaid leave.

A company holiday during leave is paid only when required by the leave classification, plan, law, or written approval.

LEV-11. Communication and return to work

The employee must provide reasonable status updates and promptly report a changed return date. Managers should maintain appropriate, non-intrusive contact and must not pressure an employee to work during approved leave.

People Operations may request fitness-for-work or restriction information when lawful and job-related. Northstar will consider temporary restrictions, gradual return, schedule changes, and accommodation. An employee must not return to safety-sensitive duties contrary to a documented restriction.

LEV-12. Confidentiality and non-retaliation

Leave and medical information is Confidential and shared only as necessary for administration, safety, payroll, benefits, accommodation, or legal obligations. Employees will not be retaliated against for requesting or using leave in good faith, supporting another employee, or reporting a concern.

LEV-13. Misuse and corrections

Northstar may investigate material inconsistencies or suspected abuse, but a manager must consult People Operations before challenging medical or protected leave. Honest errors should be corrected. Intentional falsification may lead to corrective action.

LEV-14. Examples

- Three days of flu should normally be recorded as wellness leave, not vacation PTO, when the employee has available wellness hours.
- A planned parental leave should be raised at least 30 days in advance when possible, but late notice caused by an early birth does not eliminate legal rights.
- A five-day bereavement period for a household member is paid under this policy and should not be deducted from PTO.
- A six-week personal absence may require a combination of protected leave, unpaid leave, PTO, or a formal arrangement; it is not automatically approved as personal leave.

Related policies and records

- **POL-PTO-001 - Paid Time Off and Vacation Policy**
- **POL-BEN-001 - Employee Benefits Eligibility**
- **POL-HRC-001 - HR Case Management and Escalation**
- **POL-CON-001 - Workplace Conduct and Reporting**

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New Employee Onboarding

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Metadata	Value
Policy ID	POL-ONB-001
Version	1.0
Status	Active
Effective date	2026-09-01
Review date	2027-09-01
Policy owner	People Operations
Approver	Chief People Officer
Applies to	New employees, hiring managers, People Operations, IT, Information Security, Finance, and other onboarding participants
Classification	Internal

ONB-1. Purpose

This policy establishes a consistent, secure, and welcoming onboarding process from accepted offer through the first 90 calendar days. It defines required records, access, equipment, training, role clarity, and ownership.

ONB-2. Principles

Onboarding must:

- collect only necessary information and protect it appropriately;
- provide access based on least privilege and verified role need;
- make policy, conduct, security, and reporting expectations clear;
- provide the equipment and support required for the approved work designation;
- assign accountable owners and due dates; and

- avoid granting access before required approvals, identity checks, or agreements are complete.

ONB-3. Roles

- **People Operations:** Owns the onboarding case, employment records, policy notices, eligibility, and completion tracking.
- **Hiring manager:** Defines role outcomes, schedule, work designation, access needs, training, and team integration.
- **IT:** Prepares devices, accounts, standard software, and technical support.
- **Information Security:** Applies identity, access, device, and data controls and assigns security training.
- **Finance/Payroll:** Establishes payroll, tax, expense, and purchasing records.
- **Employee:** Completes accurate forms and training, protects credentials, and raises missing or inaccessible items promptly.

ONB-4. Preboarding - accepted offer through day before start

The following should be completed or scheduled before the start date:

1. signed offer and required agreements;
2. identity and right-to-work process, where applicable;
3. tax, payroll, emergency contact, and banking information through approved secure systems;
4. employment category, Registered Home Office, manager, cost centre, and work designation;
5. benefits eligibility notice date;
6. background or credential checks authorized for the role;
7. equipment and shipping request under **POL-EQP-001**;
8. account and role-based access requests;
9. first-week schedule, orientation invitations, and onboarding buddy; and
10. accommodation or accessibility needs handled confidentially by People Operations.

Sensitive information must not be collected through ordinary email when a secure form is available.

ONB-5. Day one requirements

On day one, the employee should receive:

- identity and account activation support;
- manager welcome and role overview;
- approved work schedule and work-location expectations;
- access to policies, reporting channels, and the employee portal;
- equipment inventory and acceptable-use acknowledgement;
- payroll and timekeeping instructions; and
- a first-week plan.

A manager must not ask a new employee to share credentials or use another employee's account while access is pending.

ONB-6. Required training deadlines

Training or acknowledgement	Normal deadline
Account security, phishing, MFA, and incident reporting	Within 3 business days
Workplace conduct, harassment prevention, and reporting	Within 10 business days
Privacy and data-classification training	Within 10 business days

Training or acknowledgement	Normal deadline
Role-specific safety, compliance, or customer training	Before performing the controlled activity and no later than 30 days
Manager responsibilities, if applicable	Within 30 calendar days

Access to sensitive systems may be withheld or suspended until required training is complete.

ONB-7. First-week integration

The manager should explain team goals, decision rights, communication norms, core collaboration hours, stakeholders, current priorities, and how performance will be assessed. The employee should meet key team members and know how to request help.

For Remote or Hybrid employees, the manager should verify workspace readiness, meeting access, time-zone expectations, and planned onsite requirements. Recurring work-location rules are governed by **POL-RWK-001**.

ONB-8. 30-, 60-, and 90-day checkpoints

30-day checkpoint

Confirm role clarity, essential access, required training, payroll accuracy, benefit enrollment status, equipment, and immediate support needs.

60-day checkpoint

Review performance feedback, collaboration, workload, learning plan, and suitability of any recurring remote arrangement that was not established in the offer.

90-day checkpoint

Assess progress against initial outcomes, complete outstanding onboarding items, confirm ongoing development priorities, and close or extend the onboarding case. A checkpoint is not a guarantee of employment or a substitute for ordinary performance management.

ONB-9. Benefits and payroll

People Operations issues eligibility and enrollment notices under **POL-BEN-001**. Employees must complete elections within the stated window. Payroll questions should be reported promptly and not deferred until the 30-day checkpoint.

ONB-10. Equipment and home-office setup

IT provides the standard kit for the employee's designation under **POL-EQP-001**. Employees should not purchase a laptop or other technology expecting reimbursement. Eligible ergonomic furniture requires preapproval and is subject to the policy cap.

Equipment shipped before the start date must remain unopened by anyone other than the employee and must be stored securely. Loss or damage must be reported immediately.

ONB-11. Access control and segregation of duties

Access must be requested by an authorized manager, approved by the system owner where required, and limited to the role. Privileged, financial, HR, production, and Restricted-data access requires enhanced review. Access should be tested, but not broadened merely for convenience.

Changes identified during onboarding must use the same approval process. Shared accounts are prohibited unless Security has approved a technical exception.

ONB-12. Incomplete, delayed, or failed onboarding items

A missing item should be assigned to an owner and tracked in the onboarding case. The employee should not be penalized for a company-caused delay. However, Northstar may postpone controlled work, restrict access, or adjust duties when identity, authorization, training, equipment, or security requirements are incomplete.

A material issue, such as inability to verify work authorization, suspected record falsification, safety risk, or harassment concern, must be escalated under **POL-HRC-001**.

ONB-13. Records and privacy

Onboarding records are retained in approved HR, payroll, learning, asset, and access systems. Copies should not be stored in manager personal drives. Medical or accommodation information is stored separately with restricted access.

ONB-14. Examples

- A new Remote employee receives a company laptop and approved accessories; the employee does not buy a personal laptop for reimbursement.
- A finance employee may start general orientation while privileged payment access remains pending required approval.
- An employee hired as RFT on September 10 receives the benefits eligibility timeline described in **POL-BEN-001** and must enroll within the notice window.
- A missing security-training completion may lead to temporary access restriction but should be tracked and resolved, not ignored.

Related policies and records

- **POL-BEN-001 - Employee Benefits Eligibility**
- **POL-RWK-001 - Remote and Hybrid Work Policy**
- **POL-SEC-001 - Information Security for Remote Workers**
- **POL-EQP-001 - Company Equipment and Home Office Equipment**
- **POL-CON-001 - Workplace Conduct and Reporting**

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Company Equipment and Home Office Equipment

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Policy ID	POL-EQP-001
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Effective date	2026-09-01
Review date	2027-09-01
Policy owner	Information Technology
Approver	Chief Information Officer
Applies to	Employees and authorized contingent workers issued company equipment or approved for home-office support
Classification	Internal

EQP-1. Purpose

This policy defines standard equipment, ownership, procurement, home-office support, connectivity stipends, acceptable use, repair, replacement, loss, and return. Its goals are to provide reliable tools, control cost, protect information, and maintain accurate asset records.

EQP-2. Ownership and approved procurement

Equipment purchased or supplied by Northstar remains company property unless a written transfer says otherwise. Employees may not sell, pledge, donate, dispose of, or permanently modify company equipment.

IT procures standard technology. Employees must not purchase laptops, monitors, phones, software, cloud services, or security devices with an expectation of reimbursement unless IT and the required budget approver have approved the purchase in advance.

EQP-3. Standard equipment by work designation

Actual configuration depends on role and availability.

Work designation	Standard technology kit
Office-Based	Company laptop, charger, dock or office connection, access to office monitor and standard keyboard/mouse, role-required headset
Hybrid	Company laptop, charger, dock, one home monitor, standard keyboard/mouse, and headset when required
Remote	Company laptop, charger, dock, up to two monitors based on role, standard keyboard/mouse, headset, and webcam when needed

A role may require specialized hardware, mobile device, security key, testing equipment, or accessibility technology. Non-standard equipment requires the relevant system owner, IT, and budget approval.

EQP-4. Home-office furniture reimbursement

RFT and RPT employees with a current Hybrid or Remote designation may request preapproval for ergonomic furniture reimbursement up to **CAD 500 or USD 375 once every 36 months**. The combined limit may cover an approved chair, desk, footrest, keyboard tray, or similar ergonomic item.

The employee must submit the request before purchase and follow **POL-EXP-001**. Amounts above the limit are personal unless People Operations approves a workplace accommodation. Office-Based employees are not normally eligible because the assigned office is the primary workspace.

Reimbursed furniture normally becomes the employee's property and is not returned, unless the approval states that Northstar is purchasing and owning the item.

EQP-5. Internet and mobile connectivity

A Remote-designated employee may receive a monthly internet stipend of **CAD 50 or USD 40** through payroll or the approved stipend process. Hybrid and Office-Based employees are not normally eligible unless a written agreement or accommodation says otherwise.

The stipend supports ordinary service and does not require the employee to provide personal browsing history or a detailed household bill. It does not guarantee reimbursement of the full internet cost. Business travel connectivity is handled under **POL-EXP-001**.

Company-paid mobile service is role-based. Employees should not use a personal phone as the primary repository for company information. When personal mobile enrollment is approved, company data may be remotely removed without affecting personal content to the extent technically possible.

EQP-6. Asset records and custody

IT records the asset identifier, assigned user, serial number, configuration, issue date, and status. Employees must verify receipt and promptly report an error. Company devices should not be transferred between employees without IT authorization.

Equipment must be kept in a reasonably secure, clean, and ventilated location. Food, liquids, pets, children, visitors, and environmental conditions should be managed to reduce damage or unauthorized use.

EQP-7. Acceptable use and software

Limited incidental personal use is allowed when lawful, reasonable, secure, and not disruptive. Employees must not use equipment for unlawful activity, harassment, outside commercial work, cryptocurrency mining, unapproved high-risk software, or content that violates **POL-CON-001**.

Only approved software, extensions, and peripherals may be installed. Security controls, encryption, management agents, logs, and update settings must not be disabled.

EQP-8. Repair, replacement, and lifecycle

Employees should report faults through IT support and must not use an unapproved repair shop. IT decides whether to troubleshoot, repair, loan, or replace equipment.

Planning assumptions are a four-year laptop lifecycle and five-year monitor lifecycle, but replacement depends on security support, performance, condition, and business need. Lifecycle timing is not a personal entitlement to a new model.

Damage from normal use is covered by Northstar. Negligent, repeated, or intentional damage may be reviewed with People Operations, but managers must not deduct costs from pay without lawful authorization.

EQP-9. Loss, theft, and suspected compromise

Loss or theft of a company device, security key, badge, or phone used for MFA must be reported to IT/Security and the manager within one hour of discovery, following **POL-SEC-001**. The employee should provide location, time, device, and known circumstances and cooperate with remote lock, credential reset, police report, or insurer process.

Safety takes priority over recovering property. Employees must not confront a suspected thief.

EQP-10. International travel

Equipment taken outside the registered province, state, or country is subject to **POL-INT-001** and **POL-SEC-001**. Security may issue a temporary travel device, restrict data, or prohibit specific equipment. Employees must not place company equipment in checked baggage unless no safer option exists and Security has approved it.

EQP-11. Return and reassignment

Employees must return requested equipment in the condition reasonably expected from normal use:

- within seven calendar days after employment ends, unless the separation notice provides a shorter lawful period;
- before or promptly after a role or location change when IT requests different equipment; and
- immediately when access is suspended for a material security reason.

IT provides return instructions and, when appropriate, prepaid shipping. Employees must not wipe, reset, or discard a device before return.

EQP-12. Accessibility and accommodation

An employee who needs non-standard equipment for a disability, injury, or ergonomic restriction should contact People Operations. Accommodation-related equipment is assessed separately from the ordinary furniture cap and may require functional information, but not unnecessary diagnosis disclosure to the manager.

EQP-13. Responsibilities

Employees safeguard and return equipment. Managers identify role needs and approve legitimate non-standard requests. IT procures, supports, inventories, and disposes of assets. Security defines controls and incident response. Finance audits expenditures. People Operations handles accommodation and conduct questions.

EQP-14. Examples

- A Hybrid employee may receive one home monitor and may request a preapproved chair reimbursement up to CAD 500 once every 36 months.
- A Remote employee receives the standard internet stipend and may not also expense the same monthly internet charge.
- An employee may not buy a personal laptop and later ask for reimbursement because the company laptop was delayed.
- A stolen security key must be reported within one hour, even when no company files were stored on the key.

Related policies and records

- **POL-SEC-001 - Information Security for Remote Workers**
- **POL-RWK-001 - Remote and Hybrid Work Policy**
- **POL-EXP-001 - Business Expenses and Reimbursements**
- **POL-ONB-001 - New Employee Onboarding**

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Workplace Conduct and Reporting

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Metadata	Value
Policy ID	POL-CON-001
Version	1.0
Status	Active
Effective date	2026-09-01
Review date	2027-09-01
Policy owner	People Operations and Ethics
Approver	Chief People Officer
Applies to	Employees, officers, interns, contractors, applicants, visitors, and others interacting with Northstar personnel or systems
Classification	Internal

CON-1. Purpose and standard

Northstar is committed to a respectful, safe, inclusive, honest, and professional environment. Everyone covered by this policy must treat others with dignity, protect company and personal information, avoid improper conflicts, and report material concerns in good faith.

This policy applies in offices, remote work, business travel, customer sites, online communication, work events, social functions connected to work, and interactions involving company systems or authority.

CON-2. Respectful conduct

Expected conduct includes professional communication, reasonable collaboration, respect for boundaries, constructive disagreement, inclusive participation, and compliance with lawful instructions. A demanding deadline,

informal channel, remote setting, or senior title does not excuse abusive behavior.

Examples of unacceptable conduct include bullying, humiliation, threats, repeated hostile comments, deliberate exclusion used as punishment, sabotage, and misuse of authority. Ordinary feedback, performance management, or respectful disagreement is not misconduct merely because it is uncomfortable.

CON-3. Harassment and discrimination

Harassment, discrimination, and sexual harassment are prohibited on any protected or personal characteristic recognized by applicable law or company policy. Prohibited behavior may be verbal, visual, physical, digital, or sexual and may occur even without intent to offend.

Examples include slurs, degrading jokes, unwanted sexual attention, repeated comments about a person's body or identity, display of offensive material, conditioning work opportunities on personal or sexual conduct, and adverse treatment because a person raised a concern or requested accommodation.

A single severe incident or a pattern of less severe incidents may violate this policy.

CON-4. Retaliation

Retaliation is prohibited against a person who in good faith reports a concern, asks a question, participates in an investigation, requests leave or accommodation, refuses an unlawful instruction, or supports another person.

Retaliation may include termination, demotion, threats, schedule manipulation, exclusion, hostile scrutiny, reduced opportunity, negative references, or social pressure. A good-faith report is protected even when the concern is not substantiated. Knowingly false statements may be addressed separately.

CON-5. Violence, threats, and immediate safety

Violence, credible threats, stalking, intimidation, weapons contrary to law or site rules, and intentional property damage are prohibited. In an immediate danger, contact local emergency services first, move to safety, and then notify Security or People Operations when possible.

Do not use an ordinary HR case or AI assistant as the only response to an emergency.

CON-6. Conflicts of interest and outside activity

Employees must disclose an actual or potential conflict, including a financial interest in a supplier or customer, outside work that competes or interferes, supervision of a close personal relationship, or participation in a decision affecting a related person.

Disclosure does not automatically prohibit the activity. Northstar may approve safeguards, change decision authority, or determine that the conflict cannot be managed. Employees must not use confidential information, company time, equipment, or position for improper personal benefit.

CON-7. Gifts, entertainment, and improper influence

Gifts or entertainment must be modest, infrequent, lawful, transparent, and consistent with **POL-EXP-001**. Cash or cash equivalents are prohibited. Anything intended to influence a decision, reward improper conduct, or create an obligation must not be offered or accepted.

Government, healthcare, education, and regulated-sector interactions may require Legal or Compliance review even below ordinary limits.

CON-8. Confidentiality, privacy, and records

Employees must protect Confidential and Restricted information and comply with **POL-SEC-001**. Access is based on role need, not curiosity. Personnel, customer, investigation, payroll, and security information must not be discussed with unauthorized people or placed in public AI tools.

Employees must preserve relevant records when notified of an investigation, audit, legal hold, or security incident. Altering, hiding, or destroying evidence is prohibited.

CON-9. Communication, social media, and public statements

Employees may express personal views, but must not imply company endorsement without authority, disclose non-public information, harass colleagues, or use company branding deceptively. Only authorized spokespersons may make official public statements.

Work communication should remain professional. Recording a meeting requires notice and must comply with law and policy. Managers must not require employees to disclose personal social-media passwords.

CON-10. Substance use and fitness for work

Employees must be fit to perform duties safely and effectively. Possessing, distributing, or working while impaired by unlawful drugs or misused substances is prohibited. Lawful medication or disability-related needs should be discussed confidentially with People Operations when they may affect safety or require accommodation.

Alcohol may be served at an approved event, but participation is optional and standards of conduct remain in force.

CON-11. Reporting channels

A concern may be raised through any appropriate channel:

- a manager or next-level manager;
- People Operations through the case portal or `peopleops@northstar.example`;
- Ethics through `ethics@northstar.example`;
- Information Security for security incidents; or
- local emergency services for immediate danger.

A reporter may request confidentiality or use an available anonymous channel. Confidentiality cannot be guaranteed because Northstar may need to investigate, protect people, or comply with law. Information will be limited to those with a legitimate need.

CON-12. Manager duty to escalate

A manager who receives or observes a concern involving harassment, discrimination, retaliation, violence, credible threat, serious safety risk, fraud, or material confidentiality breach must notify People Operations, Ethics, or Security within one business day - sooner when risk is urgent. The manager must not promise secrecy, conduct an unauthorized investigation, or require the reporter to confront the subject.

Routine interpersonal issues may be coached locally, but a manager should consult People Operations when classification is uncertain.

CON-13. Investigation and fair process

Northstar will assess concerns promptly and impartially. An investigation may include interviews, documents, system records, and other relevant evidence. Participants must cooperate honestly and preserve confidentiality to the extent possible.

The subject of a concern will receive a fair opportunity to respond, consistent with safety, privacy, and investigative integrity. Northstar may use interim measures such as reporting-line changes, access restrictions, schedule changes, or paid leave. Interim measures are not findings of misconduct.

CON-14. Outcomes and corrective action

When a concern is substantiated, action may include coaching, training, process changes, warning, reassignment, loss of access, contract action, termination, restitution, or external referral. Outcomes are based on severity, intent, impact, history, consistency, and legal obligations.

Reporters and witnesses may be told that the matter was addressed, but privacy may prevent disclosure of detailed discipline.

CON-15. Examples

- A manager who receives a harassment complaint must escalate it within one business day and should not attempt a private settlement.
- An employee may disclose a supplier family relationship and be removed from the selection decision without being accused of wrongdoing.
- Repeatedly excluding an employee from essential meetings after the employee reported misconduct may be retaliation.
- An immediate threat of violence requires emergency and Security action, not only a standard HR ticket.

Related policies and records

- **POL-HRC-001 - HR Case Management and Escalation**
- **POL-SEC-001 - Information Security for Remote Workers**
- **POL-EXP-001 - Business Expenses and Reimbursements**
- **POL-LEV-001 - Statutory, Medical, and Personal Leave**

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HR Case Management and Escalation

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Policy owner	People Operations
Approver	Chief People Officer
Applies to	Employees, managers, People Operations, Ethics, Security, and support functions creating, triaging, investigating, or resolving HR-related cases
Classification	Internal

HRC-1. Purpose

This policy provides a controlled process for receiving, classifying, prioritizing, assigning, documenting, escalating, and closing HR cases. It supports timely service while protecting confidentiality, safety, evidence, and fair process.

HRC-2. Emergencies and system limits

The HR case system and AI assistant are not emergency services. A person facing immediate danger, active violence, urgent medical need, or an ongoing crime should contact local emergency services and move to safety. Security should be notified as soon as possible for an immediate workplace or information-security threat.

The AI assistant may provide policy information, collect synthetic facts, draft a summary, or create a **mock** ticket after explicit user confirmation. It must not make a final misconduct finding, diagnose a condition, promise confidentiality, send a message, alter an employee record, or take an irreversible action.

HRC-3. Intake channels

Cases may enter through:

- the HR case portal;
- peopleops@northstar.example;
- ethics@northstar.example;
- a manager or next-level manager;
- Security or IT incident escalation;
- the benefits or payroll support process; or
- an approved anonymous reporting channel.

A case received in another channel should be transferred to the appropriate controlled record when necessary. Sensitive details should not be copied into broad email lists or team chat.

HRC-4. Case categories

Category	Examples	Typical owner
Policy and employment information	PTO, holidays, remote-work rule, onboarding question	People Operations Services
Payroll and benefits	Deduction error, missing coverage, eligibility question	People Operations + Payroll/Benefits
Leave and accommodation	Medical leave, caregiving leave, work restriction, accessibility request	Restricted People Operations team
Employee relations and conduct	Harassment, discrimination, retaliation, conflict, serious manager concern	Employee Relations or Ethics
Safety and security	Threat, lost device, sensitive-data exposure, workplace incident	Security with People Operations as needed
Ethics, fraud, or financial misconduct	Expense fraud, bribery concern, record falsification	Ethics/Legal/Finance
Manager support	Coaching, performance process, team conflict, organizational change	People Operations Business Partner

One case may have multiple linked categories and owners.

HRC-5. Priority levels and service targets

Service targets begin when a sufficiently complete case reaches the responsible team. They are targets, not guaranteed resolution deadlines.

Priority	Criteria	Acknowledgement target	Initial triage or action-plan target
P1 - Critical	Immediate or credible threat, active violence, severe safety event, ongoing major data exposure, urgent risk of harm	Within 1 hour	Immediate stabilization and executive/security escalation
P2 - High	Harassment, discrimination, retaliation, serious misconduct, urgent accommodation, active treatment or pay-access issue with material hardship	Within 4 business hours	Within 1 business day
P3 - Standard	Routine leave, benefits, payroll, policy, employee-relations, or manager-support case	Within 1 business day	Within 3 business days
P4 - Information	General question, document request, low-risk clarification	Within 2 business days	Within 5 business days

A case may be reprioritized when new facts change risk. The assigned owner documents the reason.

HRC-6. Minimum intake information

A case should capture only what is necessary:

1. reporter name and employee ID, or anonymous status;
2. person or group affected;
3. issue category and concise description;
4. dates, location, and whether the issue is ongoing;
5. immediate safety, retaliation, access, pay, or medical urgency;
6. relevant documents or witnesses known to the reporter;
7. preferred safe contact method; and
8. requested help or outcome, recognizing that Northstar decides the process.

A reporter should not upload unnecessary medical records, identity documents, passwords, or unrelated personal material.

HRC-7. Triage and assignment

The receiving team checks for immediate safety, conflicts of interest, required legal or regulatory steps, data sensitivity, duplicate cases, and the correct owner. Misrouted cases are transferred without requiring the reporter to repeat the full account whenever practical.

An owner with a personal or reporting-line conflict must disclose it and be replaced. High-risk cases may require Legal, Security, Finance, Benefits, Payroll, or external expertise.

HRC-8. Confirmation before a mock action

In the educational AI application, `create_mock_hr_ticket` may be called only after the user sees a preview containing category, priority, summary, affected employee ID, and proposed routing and then explicitly confirms creation. A draft email must be clearly labelled **Draft - not sent**.

The operational trace should record the MCP tool name, arguments, returned mock case ID, policy evidence, and confirmation state. The mock system must not represent that a real employee record or external service was changed.

HRC-9. Confidentiality and access

Case information is Confidential or Restricted depending on content. Access is limited by role and need. Managers generally receive only the information needed to act; they are not automatically entitled to medical details, witness statements, or disciplinary records.

Northstar cannot promise absolute confidentiality. Information may be shared to investigate, protect people, administer leave or benefits, obtain advice, comply with law, or provide fair process. Anonymous reporting is accepted, but limited information may constrain the response.

HRC-10. Investigation and evidence

The case owner defines scope, issues, witnesses, documents, system data, and decision authority. Evidence should be collected lawfully, preserved, and recorded with source and date. Investigators must distinguish allegation, evidence, finding, and recommendation.

The AI assistant may summarize supplied synthetic information but must not infer guilt, credibility, protected status, medical diagnosis, or legal conclusion. Human review is required for sensitive triage and all findings.

HRC-11. Communication and interim measures

The reporter should receive an acknowledgement, safe contact method, and reasonable updates. Northstar may implement interim measures such as access restriction, reporting-line separation, schedule change, remote work, no-contact direction, paid leave, payroll correction, or security controls.

Interim measures protect people or evidence and are not disciplinary findings. Retaliation concerns must be treated as a new or linked case and assessed promptly.

HRC-12. Escalation matrix

Escalate immediately when a case involves:

- immediate danger, violence, threat, or severe safety event - to Security and executive response;
- suspected criminal conduct, bribery, material fraud, or legal hold - to Ethics/Legal and Finance as appropriate;
- significant data exposure or credential compromise - to Information Security;
- harassment, discrimination, retaliation, or senior-leader allegation - to Employee Relations/Ethics with conflict review;
- urgent medical accommodation or protected leave - to the restricted People Operations team; or
- repeated service failure, missed critical target, or unresolved owner conflict - to the People Operations leader.

A manager receiving a report covered by **POL-CON-001** must escalate within one business day and sooner when urgent.

HRC-13. Resolution, closure, and reopening

Before closure, the owner records the issue, steps taken, evidence considered, outcome category, actions, communications, and any follow-up date. A case may close as answered, corrected, referred, resolved, unsubstantiated, substantiated, withdrawn, duplicate, or unable to determine.

The reporter may request review when material new information exists, the process was not followed, or a conflict affected the outcome. Disagreement alone does not automatically reopen a case.

HRC-14. Records and retention

Routine policy inquiries are normally retained for two years after closure. Employee-relations, investigation, accommodation, and significant ethics cases are normally retained for seven years after closure, or longer when law, plan terms, litigation hold, or the corporate schedule requires. Access logs and deletion must follow approved records and security processes.

HRC-15. Quality and non-retaliation

People Operations periodically reviews response times, priority accuracy, repeat issues, handoffs, privacy incidents, and user feedback. Metrics must not encourage premature closure or discourage sensitive reporting.

Retaliation for good-faith reporting, participation, or use of a protected process is prohibited and should be reported as a P2 or P1 case depending on risk.

HRC-16. Examples

- A general question about PTO notice is P4 or P3 and may be answered with cited policy evidence without creating a case.
- A benefits-coverage interruption affecting active treatment is normally P2 and routed to Benefits with restricted access.
- A harassment allegation is P2, requires human Employee Relations review, and cannot be resolved by the AI assistant.
- A credible threat of violence is P1 and requires emergency/Security action rather than waiting for an ordinary case response.
- A user asking the AI assistant to create a mock PTO-support ticket must first see and confirm the proposed ticket details.

Related policies and records

- **POL-CON-001 - Workplace Conduct and Reporting**
- **POL-LEV-001 - Statutory, Medical, and Personal Leave**
- **POL-BEN-001 - Employee Benefits Eligibility**
- **POL-SEC-001 - Information Security for Remote Workers**